

On Restraint

A single page on why less is often more — rendered through the same pipeline that will produce your longer documents.

THE CASE

Good design removes what doesn't earn its place. **Every element competes for attention**, and *most attention budgets are small*. A page with fewer signals lets the remaining ones mean more.

When the default is restraint, an accent — `inline code`, a blockquote, a rule — lands with weight. When everything shouts, nothing does.

On Mono

The `JetBrains Mono` face is reserved for code, filenames, and tracked labels. Used everywhere, it would read as terminal output. Used here, it marks the signals of “system”: things the reader is meant to parse precisely.

On Sans

Archivo carries the body and the headings — one family, one voice. It is a reading face that scales up cleanly to a 21pt display heading without changing character. Its job, at body size, is to get out of the way.

On Serif

Instrument Serif appears only as ornament: the italic folio at the foot of the page, pull quotes, the suffix of a cover title. It is never used for running prose — italics inside a paragraph stay in Archivo, so the serif keeps its rarity.

THE QUOTE

Perfection is achieved, not when there is nothing more to add, but when there is nothing left to take away.

— Antoine de Saint-Exupéry, who flew mail planes.

THE ASIDE

Further reading lives at typographica.org, among other places. The links in this document render in black with an underline — enough to read as interactive, not enough to interrupt.